

Topic: The Pillars of Islam

Sub Topic: Prayer

Q (a) What are the conditions of prayer (Salat) that must be fulfilled before performing them. [10]

Answer

Para 1:

- Before starting the prayer, there are some conditions to be fulfilled before.
- The 1st and most important thing is purification. Purification is given utmost importance in Islam.
📖 Hadith: "Cleanliness is a part of Faith"
- Person who wants to offer Prayer has to make ablution (Wudu) in case of encountering with minor impurities or sleeping etc.
- Method of ablution is clearly mentioned in Holy Quran:
📖 Ref: "O you, who have believed, when you rise to [perform] prayer, wash your faces and your forearms to the elbows and wipe over your heads and wash your feet to the ankles..." [5:6]
- In case of encountering with major impurities like marital relationship etc. person has to take bath (Ghusl)
- There are 3 obligations in Ghusl, cleaning mouth, nose and spilling water over complete body in a sense that whole body gets cleaned.
- Cloths have to be clean and pure.
- The place where Prayer will be offered has to be clean.

Para 2:

- Declaration of intention (Niyyah) is also condition of Prayer because Prophet (PBUH) said:
📖 "Actions are by Intentions"
- Time of Prayer is also an important condition for offering prayer. Timings of 5 Prayers are as followed:
 1. Fajar: Starts at break of dawn and ends before sunrise.
 2. Zohr: Starts after decline of sun (Zawaal) and it can be offered till the shadow of everything gets doubled.
 3. Asr: Right after end of Zohr time and ends before sunset.
 4. Maghrib: Starts after sunset and Till the Redness (Shafaq) in horizon disappears. (Approximate duration is 30 mins)
 5. Isha: Starts after Disappearance of Redness (Shafaq) in horizon and can be offered before the break of dawn.
- 3 Times are considered Makrooh when offering prayer is not allowed. Sunrise, Zawaal (When sun is right on the heads) and sunset.

Para 3:

- Satar, means covering the specified area of the body is also an important condition for offering Prayer.
- Mandatory Satar area (That has to be covered) for men it starts from belly button till knees and for women its full body except face, hands and feet.
- Facing the Qibla is really important condition for offering prayer. Muslims would face Masjid-E-Aqsa as it was our first Kaabah. But in 2nd AH according the will of Holy Prophet (PBUH) Kaabah was changed from Masjid-e-Aqsa towards Masjid-e-Haram.

📖 Ref: "...So turn your face toward al-Masjid al-Haram. And wherever you [believers] are, turn your faces toward it..." [2:144]

Q (b) Explain the importance of Masjid in Muslim communities. [04]

Answer

- Mosque plays a vital role in shaping an ideal Muslim community.
- The first thing done by Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) upon reaching Quba was construction of Taqwa/Quba Mosque and later on upon reaching Madinah he built Mosque of Prophet.
- The concept of Mosque is not just a worship place, but it works as a community center for Muslims where they can gather talk/find solutions for their religious, social, economic, legal and political problems.
- In the era of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) Mosques were used Military Head Quarter, Court, School, Parliament and community center.
- ❖ Hadith: "The most beloved of places to Allah are the mosques..." [Muslim]

Q (a) Describe the particular features of congregational prayers, both daily and on Fridays (Jum'ah prayers). [10]

Answer

Para 1:

- Religion varies to 'A set of rituals'. Islam is not only a religion but it's a code of conduct. Every act and worship in Islam has social, physical and spiritual impacts on worshippers.
- Allah orders Muslims to offer prayer in congregation.
 - ❖ Ref: "And establish prayer and give zakah and bow with those who bow [in worship and obedience]" [2:43]
- Only Fardh are supposed to be offered in congregation. Its recommended to offer Nafil at home.
- It has great rewards and significance in Islam. Prophet (PBUH) said about significance of Prayer in congregation:
 - ❖ "It better to join another person and pray than to pray alone and it is more superior in the company of two men and the bigger the congregation the more liked it is by Allah." [Abu Dawud]
- Azan will be called.
- According to Prophet's (PBUH) instruction even if there is a single man with another woman or child, they should offer prayer in congregation.
- Usually, followers are instructed to make straight queues behind Imam and Imam has been instructed to check the accurate straightness of lines.
 - ❖ Hadith: "Straighten your rows, for straightening the rows is part of establishing prayer." [Bukhari]
- If Imam is leading only a single follower, he/she would stand on right side of Imam. In case another follower comes, Imam will move forward or 1st follower will be dragged backwards to make proper line behind Imam.
- The best person to lead congregation is the one who is best at recitation of Holy Quran. Understanding of Quran and Hadith and character is also criteria of being worthy to lead prayer.
- Imam is instructed to manage the time/speed in order to facilitate weak and aged followers as instructed by Holy Prophet (PBUH).
 - ❖ Hadith: Anas bin Malik (RA) says that: "I have not prayed behind anyone who prayed a lighter Salah or a more complete prayer than that of the Prophet (PBUH)" [Agreed]

- 'Iqamah' is called as a caution to worshiper to form straight lines. After making intention Imam starts prayer with Takbeer-e-Tehreema and followers follow him throughout the prayer as its already discussed in method of prayer.

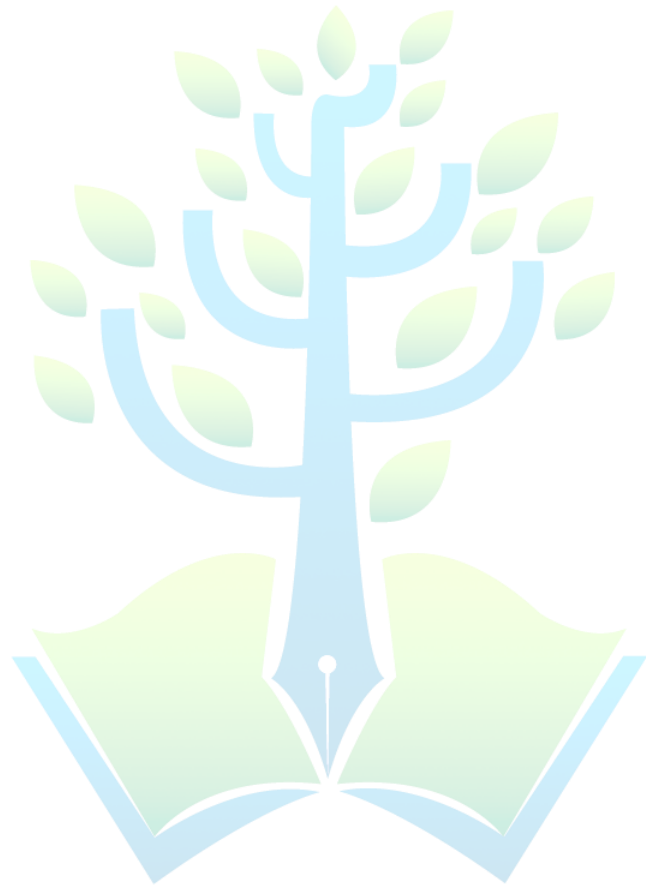
Para 2:

- Friday is regarded as special day for Muslims.
 - ❖ Hadith: ""The best day during which the sun have risen is Friday. It is the Day Adam was created. It is the day when Adam entered paradise and also when he was taken out from it. It is also the day on which the Day of Judgment takes place." [Muslim]
- Friday congregational Prayer has been given the special importance in Islam.
 - ❖ Ref: "O you who have believed, when [the adhan] is called for the prayer on the day of Jumu'ah [Friday], then proceed to the remembrance of Allah and leave trade. That is better for you, if you only knew." [62:09]
- Men are instructed to abandon their economic and social affairs and rush towards preparation of prayer.
- In some communities, women are also encouraged to join Friday prayer in congregation.
- According to Sunnah of Holy Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) special preparation for this prayer is highly recommended. Prophet (PBUH) would take bath, use best perfume, wear best clothes and reach mosque in time.
- There 2 Azans for Jummah. Muslims are ordered to start preparation after listening to first Azaan.
- In this era, it's a common practice that a speech is delivered by Imam in native language before Friday sermon in Arabic.
- After second Azan Imam delivers two sermons in Arabic that mostly start with Testifying Shahadah and Prophethood of Holy Prophet (PBUH) then main focus of these sermons remains on righteousness and rights of Allah and his creation.
- These sermons have special significance:
 - ❖ Hadith: When the Friday comes, at every door of the Masjid there stands Angels who write down (the names of) those who come First, then who comes next. When the Imam sits down, the records are closed and they come to listen to the reminder, i.e. the sermon...." [Muslim]
- 2 Raka'at fardh are offered in congregation and there is no Qadha of Friday Prayer.
- People who are exempted from Jummah are:
 - ❖ Hadith: "The Friday prayer in congregation is an obligatory duty on every Muslim except four: a slave, a woman, a child, and a sick person." [Abu Dawood]

(b) How do the two Eids bring the Muslim community together? [4]

Answer

- Eid is a great festival for Muslims as they get together, meet and greet each other, share their happiness which strengthens the bond of Muslim brotherhood.
- On Eid-ul-Fitr the blessed ones pay Sadaqa-tul-Fitr a mandatory charity which is a great tool to share happiness of eid with less privileged and downtrodden people of society.
- On Eid-ul-Azha the ritual of animal sacrifice which is done to follow the sunnah of Prophet Ibrahim (AS) is a great economic and social activity. The buying/selling of animals, transportation and sacrificial process causes circulation of wealth and creates millions of temporary jobs. Moreover, less privileged people get to eat the meat which is not affordable for them during normal days.



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